

Impact High · Difficulty Easy-Medium · Misuse risk A precise ask can sound like an order when it drops context, choice or an

THE MOVE

Context in one line -> specific action -> specific object -> specific output -> boundary or opt-out. -> Full: "Because [context], could you [action] [object] and send me [output] by [time]? No problem if that is not feasible." -> Minimum: ?

START HERE

Ask for one specific action on one specific object, with one clear output.

SAY THIS

Quick / one-liners	<i>"Could you answer just this part?"</i>
Digital / text	<i>"Could you reply with yes/no on option B by 3 pm? Detail can wait."</i>
Close & personal	<i>"Could you tell me what you need from me tonight: listening, problem-solving or space?"</i>
Work & meetings	<i>"Could you review the two highlighted risks and tell me whether either blocks approval?"</i>
Naming the exact ask	<i>"Could you decide whether the launch date moves or stays?"</i>
Softening & opt-out	<i>"No problem if the answer is no; I mainly wanted to make the ask clear."</i>

AVOID

- The other person is upset and needs to feel heard before anything is asked of them
- The relationship needs empathy or repair before action
- The real ask is large and must be named honestly rather than shrunk to sound easy

REMEMBER

Find the verb before you ask.